

Build Spec — minimoi.ai Preview Layer + Mein Deutsch Animation

mini-moi · Guild Created: 2026-06-14 — Claude.ai Design input: Grok (animation), Claude Code (technical investigation) Status: spec_ready For: Claude Code Depends on: design_preview_guest_access_2026-06-13.md (design rationale)

Overview

Build the always-on preview layer for minimoi.ai in three workstreams, sequenced below. This is what a recruiter or interviewer sees when they click through from LinkedIn or GitHub — the site needs to be up, real, and impressive without requiring Robert to be online.

Workstream order:

1. Snapshot capture + `/preview` routing + admin modal (core — always-on)
 2. Mein Deutsch animated walkthrough (the standout demo piece)
 3. Guest access audit + entry point (verify existing plumbing works)
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Workstream 1 — Snapshot Capture + `/preview` Routing

Decision: `/preview` path, not subdomain

Serve preview at `minimoi.ai/preview/...` from Flask's static directory. No DNS change, no separate host. Flask serves the static files whether or not the backend is running (confirm this is true with the current setup — if Flask must be up to serve static files, Cloudflare Pages for `/preview` is the fallback, but the `/preview` path stays the same either way).

Capture script: `tools/capture_snapshot.py`

Use **Playwright** (headless Chromium) not simple HTTP requests. Rationale: several pages (Guild Daily Briefing, Build Queue) render state via JS after page load — simple requests would capture incomplete HTML. Playwright captures the fully-rendered DOM.

Script behavior:

1. Authenticates as owner (reads credentials from `.env`), never hardcoded)
2. Visits each page in the manifest (see below), waits for JS render to settle (`networkidle`)

3. Saves rendered HTML + inlines CSS to `static/preview/<domain>/<page>.html`
4. Injects snapshot banner into each saved page (see banner spec below)
5. Replaces all admin-tab `<a>` href links with `data-admin-blocked="true"` attribute (triggers modal — see admin modal spec below)
6. Replaces all form POSTs and write-action buttons with `disabled` + a `data-preview-disabled="true"` attribute
7. For Career Focus: applies Option A — excludes pipeline table, shows only aggregate counts ("12 opportunities, 1 interview") — see rationale in design doc
8. Writes `static/preview/manifest.json`:

```
json
{
  "captured_at": "2026-06-14T07:30:00Z",
  "pages": [...],
  "failures": [...]
}
```

9. Prints summary to stdout

Run command:

```
bash

python tools/capture_snapshot.py
```

Pages to capture (manifest):

Domain	Page	URL
Curator	Daily Briefing	/curator
Curator	Deeper Dive (pick most recent)	/curator/dive/<id>
Curator	Archive	/curator/archive
Mein Deutsch	Landing/Lesen	/german
Mein Deutsch	Gespräche	/german/gesprache
Mein Deutsch	Wörter	/german/worter
Mein Deutsch	Schreiben	/german/schreiben
Mein Deutsch	Archiv	/german/archiv
Guild	Daily Briefing	/guild
Guild	Build Log	/guild/build
Guild	Queue	/guild/build/queue
Guild	Roadmap	/guild/build/roadmap

Career Focus (/guild/career) — captured but pipeline table replaced with aggregate view before save (see Option A above).

Snapshot banner

Injected at top of <body> on every preview page. Non-dismissable.

```
html

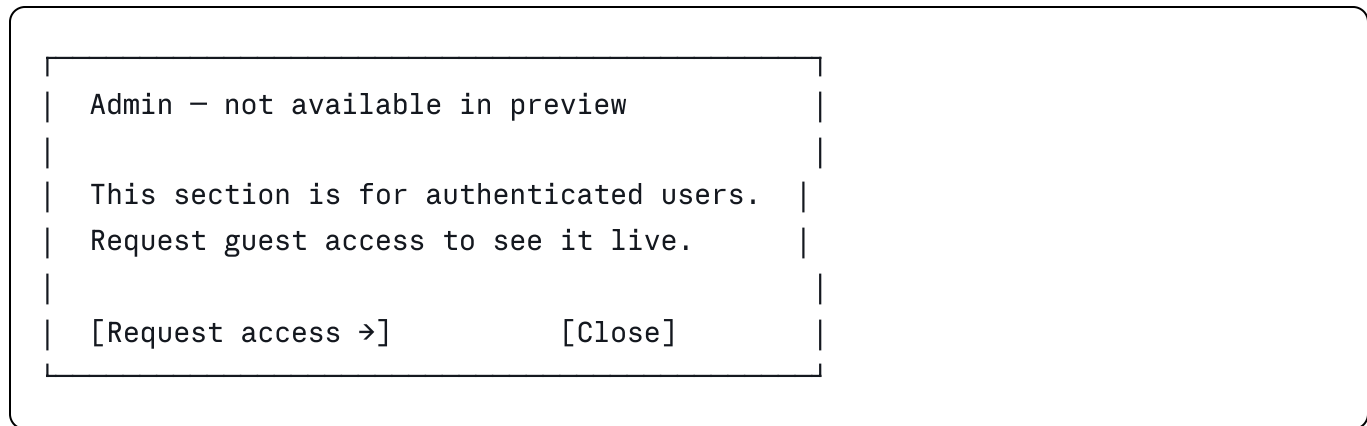
<div class="preview-banner">
  <span>Preview snapshot - </span>
  <span class="preview-date">Captured June 2026</span>
  <span>. Data is real but frozen. </span>
  <a href="/contact" class="preview-request-link">Request guest access →</a>
</div>
```

CSS: thin bar, (background: #2A1F14), (color: #F5F0E8), amber accent on the link (#C68A5E). (position: sticky; top: 0; z-index: 999). Does not obscure nav (nav sits below it).

The date ("June 2026") is written dynamically by the capture script from `captured_at` in the manifest.

Admin tab modal

Any element with `data-admin-blocked="true"` triggers this modal on click:



"Request access →" links to `/contact` (or Robert's chosen entry point — see Workstream 3). "Close" dismisses. Dark overlay behind modal. CSS only — no framework dependency.

Preview navigation

Each preview page keeps the real site nav but with:

- All links pointing to other preview pages (`/preview/...`) not live pages
- "Dashboard →" button in the nav replaced with: `<a href="/contact" class="nav-dashboard-preview">Request Access →</a>`
- Preview banner always visible above nav

The capture script handles link rewriting — replace all internal hrefs with their `/preview/...` equivalent, leave external links (GitHub, LinkedIn) untouched.

Refresh workflow

Robert runs `python tools/capture_snapshot.py` monthly or after a major feature ships. The script overwrites `static/preview/` in place. Git-commit the updated static files and push — Cloudflare tunnel picks them up on next request.

A note in `docs/ROADMAP.md` under Operations: "Monthly preview refresh — run `capture_snapshot.py`, commit + push."

Workstream 2 — Mein Deutsch Animated Walkthrough

Design: Grok + Claude.ai. Implemented as CSS + JS, no video files, fully static.

Placement

Embedded in the Gespräche tab of the Mein Deutsch preview section — appears above the static snapshot of the Gespräche page. The animation is a self-contained `<div class="md-walkthrough">` block; the static snapshot sits below it as supporting context.

Trigger

Auto-play on scroll into view using Intersection Observer API. Fires once when the `.md-walkthrough` div enters the viewport. Does not re-fire on scroll. "⌂ Replay" button appears on completion and resets + replays from Step 1 on click.

A subtle "► Watch demo" button sits above the animation container — visible before the animation starts, disappears once it fires. This acts as a fallback for desktop visitors where the section may already be in view on load (Intersection Observer may not fire for content visible on initial render in all browsers).

A subtle "► Watch it work" label pulses gently (amber, 1s fade cycle) before the animation starts, so visitors who scroll fast know something is about to play.

Total runtime: 45–55 seconds

Animation steps

Step 1 — Persona selection (6–7s)

- Show the persona card grid (3–4 cards visible)
- "Maria" card (Café Waitress, Vienna) gently lifts (~3px translateY) and gets an amber glow border (`box-shadow: 0 0 12px #C68A5E`)
- Transition: soft fade-in on grid, then lift+glow on Maria

Step 2 — Scene selection (5–6s)

- Persona grid fades out, scene list fades in
- "At the café" row highlights with an amber left-border pulse
- Transition: crossfade

Step 3 — Voice conversation (20–24s)

- Show the Gespräche conversation panel
- Speaker labels: "Maria" (left, amber) and "Sie" (right, parchment)
- **4 turns, lightly condensed from a real session:**

Maria: Guten Morgen! Was darf ich Ihnen bringen?
Sie: Ich möchte ein Kaffee, bitte.
Maria: Einen Kaffee – gerne. Möchten Sie auch etwas essen?
Sie: Ja, ich nehme ein Croissant, danke.

Note: "ein Kaffee" (should be "einen Kaffee") is the real mistake — Maria's echo ("Einen Kaffee — gerne") subtly models the correction without interrupting the scene. This is authentic to how the tool works. Conversation content will be updated with a real session excerpt once Robert provides transcripts to Grok — placeholder above is illustrative.

- Typing animation: each line types in character by character at **60ms/char** (natural reading pace), with a 600ms pause between turns
- Voice button shown as subtly active/glowing during "Sie" turns — amber pulse, low intensity, should not distract from the conversation text

Step 4 — Transcript submission (6-7s)

- Conversation panel fades slightly
- "Submit" button pulses amber and appears to be clicked (scale: 0.97, then back to 1.0, 150ms)
- Status message appears: "Submitting transcript..."
- "Send to Telegram" button is **visible in the UI but not animated** — shown as a secondary option with a small label beneath it: "or send via Telegram" (plain text, parchment, small)
- Transition: clean, no jarring flash

Step 5 — AI Review + Anki cards (10-12s)

- Review panel fades in with 3 feedback items appearing sequentially (300ms stagger):

✓ Guter Einstieg – natürlicher Gesprächsfluss
▲ "ein Kaffee" → "einen Kaffee" (Akkusativ, maskulin)
✓ Croissant-Antwort korrekt und natürlich

- Then 3 Anki cards appear in a card-stack animation (fan out, 400ms):

[Front: einen Kaffee | Back: a coffee (Akkusativ)]
[Front: Was darf ich Ihnen bringen? | Back: What can I bring you?]
[Front: Ich nehme... | Back: I'll have...]

- Final frame holds for 2s, then "⌂ Replay" appears bottom-right in amber

CSS/JS constraints

- No external libraries (pure CSS transitions + vanilla JS)
- No video files, no canvas, no WebGL
- Self-contained in one `<script>` block + one `<style>` block in the page
- Works without a running backend (static HTML)
- Respects `prefers-reduced-motion` — if set, skip typing animation, show steps as instant fades instead

Sample conversation

The 5-turn exchange above uses a real mistake ("ein Kaffee") and real vocabulary from Mein Deutsch sessions. If a better real-session excerpt exists in the transcripts, Claude Code can substitute — criteria: 4-5 turns, at least one natural mistake, one scene-setting question from Maria, ends on a complete-feeling exchange.

Workstream 3 — Guest Access Audit + Entry Point

Audit checklist (investigate + fix if broken)

- ☐ `/register` form works end-to-end
- ☐ Telegram alert fires to Robert on signup
- ☐ What happens after Robert receives the alert? Is there a `/approve` route, or does Robert manually update the DB? Document the current mechanism; if it's manual DB, add a simple `/admin/approve/<user_id>` route
- ☐ What does a guest session actually see? `/guest/briefing` — is this real Curator content? Is it read-only enforced at the route level, or just by convention?
- ☐ Guest session revocation — is there a clean way to remove access? If not, add `is_active` flag to guest accounts + admin toggle

Entry point

The preview snapshot banner contains:

Request live access →

This links to `/contact` — a simple contact page (or anchor on the landing page) with:

- Robert's LinkedIn DM link

- A note that guest access is available on request

Do not link to `/register` directly. Keep guest access on-request-only. No public self-service signup.

Optional (low priority): a lightweight request form on `/contact` (name, email, "why you're interested") that sends a Telegram message to Robert without granting access. Robert responds personally. Flag as optional scope — implement only if Robert confirms he wants it.

Definition of Done

Workstream 1:

- ☐ `tools/capture_snapshot.py` runs cleanly, captures all pages in manifest, writes `static/preview/` and `manifest.json`
- ☐ `/preview/...` routes serve static files correctly — accessible without backend running (or via Cloudflare Pages if Flask static serving doesn't meet this requirement)
- ☐ Snapshot banner appears on every preview page, date accurate, link functional
- ☐ Admin tabs trigger modal on click, not navigation
- ☐ All write-action buttons/forms disabled in preview
- ☐ Career Focus shows aggregate only (Option A)
- ☐ Internal links point to `/preview/...` equivalents, external links (GitHub, LinkedIn) untouched
- ☐ "Dashboard →" replaced with "Request Access →" in preview nav
- ☐ Robert runs script, commits output, confirms live at `minimoi.ai/preview`

Workstream 2:

- ☐ Animation embedded in Mein Deutsch Gespräche preview page
- ☐ Auto-plays on scroll into view (Intersection Observer)
- ☐ All 5 steps animate correctly at correct timing
- ☐ "Send to Telegram" button visible but not animated
- ☐ "⏮ Replay" appears on completion, replays correctly
- ☐ `prefers-reduced-motion` respected
- ☐ Works in latest Chrome, Firefox, Safari (static HTML, no backend)
- ☐ Robert watches it and approves

Workstream 3:

- ☐ Audit findings documented (what works, what needs fixing)

- ☐ Any broken guest access flows fixed
 - ☐ `/contact` page or anchor exists, linked from preview banner
 - ☐ Robert confirms guest access works end-to-end with a test account
-

Commit

bash

Workstream 1

```
git add tools/capture_snapshot.py static/preview/ docs/ROADMAP.md
git commit -m "feat: minimoi.ai always-on preview layer"
```

Snapshot capture script (Playwright), /preview routing, snapshot banner, admin modal, write-action disabling, Career Focus Option A (aggregate only). Internal links rewritten to /preview/..., external links preserved. Mein Deutsch animation placeholder in Gespräche tab."

Workstream 2

```
git add static/preview/german/gesprache.html
git commit -m "feat: Mein Deutsch animated walkthrough in preview"
```

CSS/JS animation, 45-55s, 5 steps: persona selection, scene selection, voice conversation (5 turns, real mistake visible), submission, AI review + 3 Anki cards. Auto-play on scroll, Replay button, prefers-reduced-motion respected. Send to Telegram visible but not animated (Phase 1)."

Workstream 3

```
git add <guest access files>
git commit -m "fix/feat: guest access audit + /contact entry point"
```

[describe findings and fixes]"

Notes for Grok (Phase 2+ deferred items)

- Animate the Telegram submission path — Phase 3, optional, not in scope
- "Send to Telegram" visible but static in Phase 1 (per Grok spec)
- If Robert wants a video version of the walkthrough as an alternative (e.g., embedded on LinkedIn), the animation above can be screen-recorded from the live preview page — no separate production needed

